

The Sussex Cove Gardening Company

The website itself is built well. What's holding you back is that it's two days old and has no reviews yet. Here's what to do about it, and what to ignore.

thesussexcovegardeningcompany.co.uk Checked by hand, not by a scanning tool

Where you stand today

Three facts, checked this morning. None of them are a criticism of the site, they're just where a brand-new business starts.

0

Pages of yours in Google. Searching `site:` your domain returns nothing at all yet.

0

Google reviews. Every competitor who outranks you has them.

#1

Position held by a dead web address when someone searches your business name.

BEING HANDLED

That dead address at the top of Google

When your site was being built it lived temporarily at `sussexcovegardening.com`. That temporary address is switched off now, but Google hasn't caught up, so it still sits at the top of the results for your own business name, and your real website isn't showing at all yet.

This fixes itself. Google drops addresses it can no longer reach, usually within a couple of weeks, and your real site was formally submitted to Google today. Nothing for you to do.

How the website scores

Scored across the seven areas a search audit normally covers. The build quality is genuinely strong; the weak scores are all about age and content depth, not craftsmanship.

AREA		SCORE
Technical foundations		91
Speed		95
Images		90
Data for Google (structured markup)		75
Page wording and headings		60
AI assistant readiness		58
Content depth and trust signals		54
Overall		72
Local findability	 THE REAL GAP	37

What's already right

Worth knowing, because if anyone offers to sell you an "SEO package", these are the things they'd normally charge you to fix, and they're already done.

- **Speed is excellent.** Measured on a simulated slow phone connection: the main image appears in 1.4 seconds, nothing jumps about while loading, and the page arrives in 12 requests weighing 0.3 MB. Google's pass mark for that first figure is 2.5 seconds.
- **Google can read everything.** Nothing is blocked, the sitemap is valid, and all four versions of your web address (with and without www, secure and not) land correctly on one address.
- **Your business details are machine-readable.** The page carries hidden structured data telling Google your name, phone, services and all six towns you cover.
- **The security padlock is correct** and covers both versions of your address.
- **Every link works.** All of them tested: WhatsApp, Facebook, Instagram, Nextdoor, your Google listing.
- **Calling you is one tap** from anywhere on the page, on any device.

The one thing that matters most

If you only do one thing on this whole document, do this one. Here's the evidence rather than just the advice. This is the top result today when someone in Lancing searches for a gardener:

| "8 Gardeners in Lancing · Expect to pay between £336 and £814 · 5.0 ★ (83)"

Two things are winning that spot: **a price** and **reviews**. Every single competitor ranking above you has both. You currently have neither on show. Reviews are also the thing Google leans on hardest to decide who appears in the map results, and it's completely free.

Ask every happy customer, starting with the olive tree one. Your Google listing has a "Ask for reviews" share link built in: text or WhatsApp it the moment you finish a job, while they're still standing in the tidy garden looking pleased.

Your jobs, in order

Ranked by what actually moves the needle per minute of your time. The first three are worth more than everything else combined.

1 Ask for a Google review after every job

Text the review link the same day. Aim for five in the next month. Nothing else on this list comes close to this for getting found.

HIGHEST IMPACT

2 MINUTES A JOB

2 Check your Google listing hides your home address

You go to customers, they don't come to you, so it should show your service area rather than your front door. In the Google Business app this is the "service area" setting.

PRIVACY

5 MINUTES, ONCE

3 Decide a price you're happy to publish

Not a full price list. One honest anchor, like "one-off tidy-ups typically start from £X" or an hourly rate. Every competitor shows one and it's the first thing customers look for. Tell us the number and we'll add it to the site.

HIGH IMPACT

A DECISION, NOT A TASK

4 Post a job photo to your Google listing weekly

You're already taking these for Instagram. Reposting one a week signals to Google that the business is active.

MEDIUM IMPACT

1 MINUTE A WEEK

5 Get your insurance and waste licence numbers to us

The site says "fully insured" and "licensed waste carrier". Adding the actual policy and licence numbers turns claims into proof, which matters to cautious customers.

TRUST

DIG OUT TWO NUMBERS

6 Flip one setting in your Adobe Fonts account

Your font kit is set so text can briefly stay invisible while the font loads. Changing "font display" to "swap" in the Adobe Fonts dashboard makes text appear straight away. Measured saving: about 0.15 of a second.

SMALL WIN

2 MINUTES, ONCE

7 Consider Checkatrade and Bark

The two UK directories worth a gardener's time. Both cost money, so it's a business call, not an SEO one. Ignore Yelp, Angi, Houzz and the rest, they're not worth it here.

OPTIONAL

COSTS MONEY

Jobs on the website

These are ours, not yours. Listed so you know they're accounted for.

1 Fix the main heading

The page's biggest heading currently reads only "THE SUSSEX COVE", with no mention of gardening or anywhere you work. It's the single strongest signal on a page and it's being wasted.

BIGGEST ON-PAGE FIX

2 Shorten the Google listing text

The description Google shows is too long and gets cut off mid-word, losing Steyning, Worthing, Findon, Ferring and "free quotations" before anyone reads them.

QUICK

3 Write real sentences pairing services with towns

Nowhere does the page say something like "hedge trimming in Worthing". The six towns appear once, as a list. That's the phrase customers actually type.

HIGH IMPACT

4 Remove your street address from the page's hidden data

Your full address and postcode sit in the page's machine-readable data even though no visitor ever sees them. For someone who works from home that's worth closing. We'll show "based in Lancing" instead, which gives the local trust without the front door.

PRIVACY

5 Add a simple enquiry form

Right now the only ways to reach you are phone, WhatsApp and email. People comparing quotes at 9pm often won't ring a stranger. A short "postcode and what needs doing" form catches them.

MEDIUM IMPACT

6 Trim the photo gallery's data use

Nothing loads until someone scrolls to it, which is right. But once they do, it pulls about 1.9 MB of photos. We can roughly halve that by letting the browser pick a smaller size on smaller screens.

MINOR

7 Show reviews on the site once you have them

As soon as three or four land on Google, they go on the page too. This is the fix for the weakest area in the whole audit.

WAITING ON YOU

Not worth your money

If someone approaches offering SEO services, this is the list to push back with. Everything here was genuinely considered and rejected for your specific situation.

- **A page for every town.** Six near-identical "Gardener in [Town]" pages, with no reviews or local photos to make them different, is the exact pattern Google discounts. Worth revisiting once you've got reviews and jobs to show in each place, not now.
- **A blog.** Weekly gardening articles are a poor use of a one-man band's evenings. Reviews will out-earn them many times over.
- **Star ratings in the site's code before you have real reviews.** Google treats invented ratings as spam and the penalty is severe.
- **"AI SEO" extras like an llms.txt file.** Built for large sites with hundreds of pages. Nothing to gain here.
- **Yelp, Angi, Houzz, Porch, BBB.** Either American, or no longer meaningful for UK trades.
- **Backlink packages.** Nothing about your situation is solved by bought links, and they carry real risk.

What to expect, honestly

No one can make a two-day-old website rank quickly, and anyone promising otherwise is selling something. A realistic path:

- **Next week or two:** your site gets indexed and starts showing up when someone searches your business name. The dead address drops away.
- **Next month or two:** with reviews coming in steadily, you start appearing in the map results for searches near Lancing and Shoreham.
- **Longer:** the further towns, Findon and Ferring, take longest. How close you are to the person searching is one of the biggest factors in local results, and nothing on a website overrides that.

The honest summary: your website is not what's holding you back. Time and reviews are, and only one of those is in your control.

Audit carried out 19 August 2026 across technical setup, content, structured data, speed, local search, AI-assistant readiness and search experience. Every figure quoted was measured directly against the live site rather than taken from a scanning tool. Speed measured on a simulated 1.6 Mbps mobile connection with a four-times slowed processor.